



How I Screwed “Get Rich Slow”

*The object of life is not to be on the side of the masses,
but to escape finding oneself in the ranks of the insane.*

~ MARCUS AURELIUS

EXPOSING THE “GET RICH SLOW” DREAMKILLER

As a teenager, I never gave myself a chance of becoming wealthy young. “Wealth + youth” was an equation that didn’t compute simply because I didn’t have the physical capabilities. Common roads to wealth for the young are competitive and require talent; become an actor, a musician, an entertainer or a pro athlete—all roads that had a big “ROAD CLOSED” sign that laughed, “Not a chance, MJ!”

So, early in life, I conceded. I gave up on my dreams. “Get Rich Slow” made it abundantly clear: Go to school, get a job, settle for less, sacrifice, be miserly and quit dreaming about financial freedom, mountainside homes, and exotic cars. But I still dreamed. It’s what teenage boys do. For me, it was all about the cars—specifically, the Lamborghini Countach.

THE 90 SECONDS THAT CHANGED MY LIFE

I grew up in Chicago and was a porky kid with few friends. I wasn’t interested in teenage girls or sports, but lying around in a beanbag stuffing my face with doughnuts while watching Tom-n-Jerry reruns. Parental supervision was absent; Mom divorced Dad years earlier, which left my older siblings and me to be raised by a single mother. Mom didn’t have a college education or a career, unless a deep-frying job at Kentucky Fried Chicken qualified. That left me to my own indulgences, usually consumption of sweets and the latest episode of the *A-Team*. My exertions were epitomized by a long broken broomstick: I used it as the TV’s remote control since the real one was broken and I was too lazy to move. When I did move, the